THE LAST LEAF OF AUTUMN



Created by Hamidreza Rostami

Rustle loved his branch.
It was the perfect branch,
high up in the great maple tree.
Just the right spot for
catching the morning sun.
Just the right place
for feeling the cool breeze.
And it was the perfect branch
for watching the world.

Rustle had spent all
spring growing.
All summer dancing
in the wind. And now,
autumn had come.

The other leaves were changing.
Turning gold. Turning red.
Turning orange. And one by one,
they were letting go.



“Time to go, Rustle!” called
his friend Amber, as she
twirled down to the ground.

“The ground is soft!” said
Golden, landing beside her.
“And the wind is fun!”

But Rustle
shook his stem.
“I am not ready.
Not yet.”

The days grew cooler.
The winds grew stronger.
More leaves fell.
The tree was getting bare.



"You will be the last one!"
called Crimson, as she
fluttered down.
"That is okay," Rustle said.
"I like it here."

Then, one morning,
Rustle noticed something.
He was changing too.
His edges were turning.
From green to gold.
From gold to red.



He was becoming beautiful.



“You are the most beautiful leaf
on the tree!” said a blue jay.
Rustle blushed, if a leaf can blush.
“Do you really think so?”
“Of course!” said the blue jay.
“Look at you! All those colours!”

But then the blue jay flew away, and Rustle was alone again.

The wind blew.
Stronger this time.
Rustle held on tight.
“I am not ready,” he whispered.



That night, Rustle
heard a soft sound.
It was the wind, singing
through the branches.



"Let go, little one," the wind whispered. "It is time."

"But I do not want to fall," Rustle said.

"Falling is not the end," the wind said. "It is the beginning of something new."

Rustle thought about what the wind had said. He looked down at the ground, coverd in a soft colourful carpet of leaves. He looked up at the sky, clear and full of stars. And he looked at himself. He was the most beautiful he had ever been.

The next morning, the sun rose.
The wind blew gently.
And Rustle made a decision.
He took a deep breath,
if a leaf can breathe.
He loosened his grip.
And he let go.


The wind carried Rustle down,
gently, like a lullaby.
He twirled. He danced.
Falling was not scary.
It was wonderful.

That afternoon, a little girl named Emma came walking through the park. She saw the pile of leaves and smiled. She picked up Rustle and held him high. “You are the most beautiful of all!” she said. And Rustle knew. He had not disappeared. He had just begun a new adventure.



Rustle the maple leaf loves his branch. It is the perfect branch, high in the great maple tree, with the best view in the whole park.

When autumn comes and every other leaf lets go, Rustle holds on. He is not ready. Not yet.

A warm story about courage, change, and discovering that letting go can be the beginning of something beautiful.

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